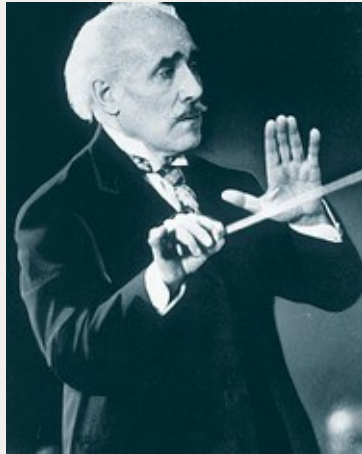


IN PROFILE

Arturo Toscanini

The conductor most associated with Puccini operas, Toscanini was born in Parma, Italy, in 1867. He was a cellist before stepping up to conduct Verdi's *Aida* in Rio de Janeiro at the age of 19. Building a reputation as a conductor of exceptional intensity, he was appointed musical director of La Scala in Milan in 1898 and of New York's Metropolitan Opera House in 1908. In 1915, he returned to Italy to support his country in World War I. Eventually settling in the US, he became a popular celebrity, conducting the NBC Symphony Orchestra from 1937. Toscanini died in 1957.



ARTURO TOSCANINI (1867–1957), IN HIS LATER YEARS

Making operatic history

Always working slowly, plagued by quarrels over rights to material and by struggles with librettists, over the next decade